

Session 21: The Triumph of Christ

Key Takeaways

- Jesus shares all authority in Heaven and Earth with God the Father and confers that authority to his disciples for them to advance his Kingdom on Earth.
- The early Church fathers rejected any sense of subordination of Jesus to God the Father, stating their co-equality (e.g., co-divine, co-eternal, etc.).
- The belief that Jesus is both fully God and fully human remains crucial to the Christian faith.
- The resurrection is Jesus' victory over death and evil and is a source of life and power for us, promising hope for the entire world.

The Triumph of Christ

To describe Christ's victory over the powers, Paul again uses the verb *katargeó* (annul, abolish, destroy).

1 Corinthians 15:24-28 NIV*

²⁴ Then the end will come, when Christ hands over the kingdom to God the Father after he has destroyed (Greek: *καταργήσῃ* / *katargēsē*) all dominion, authority and power. ²⁵ For he must reign until he has put all his enemies under his feet. ²⁶ The last enemy to be destroyed is death. ²⁷ For he "has put everything under his feet." Now when it says that "everything" has been put under him, it is clear that this does not include God himself, who put everything under Christ. ²⁸ When he has done this, then the Son himself will be made subject to him who put everything under him, so that God may be all in all.

*Key Words Adapted by Teacher

Psalm 8 says everything is put under humanity's feet. Psalm 8 and Psalm 110 (footstool imagery) are brought together here. These two psalms are also combined in Ephesians 1:20-22 and Hebrews 2:5-8.

Christ will be established as Lord of all creation, and he will bring about the renewal of all things. What we do in our bodies in this life matters because this body will be resurrected.

Reflection Question

What questions do you have about the Trinity or the relationship between God the Father and God the Son?